Yarnao Agricultural Labour Exchange

Resource Identifier: CULT-CUST-003

English Translation: Peer Labor Group Cooperative

Category: Custom | Subcategory: Agricultural

Village / Region: Ukhrul | Dialect: Ukhrul

Contributor / Source: Tangkhul Youth & Farming Peer Groups (Documented in Ruivah 1993)

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Seasonal Timing / Occasion: Sowing, transplantation, and harvest agricultural seasons

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Ethnographic Summary & Context:

Mutual assistance cooperative where groups of young men and women rotate work across each member’s terraced fields during sowing and harvesting seasons.

Indigenous Tangkhul Text / Chants / Sayings:

"Yarnao mibingna ot kachida ngasoda luisang ot sai."
"Aja iwui luili, khama nawui luili, ringkaphada ngachon."
"Monsoon kazingli phungrei kongrei thata luisang kashung."

English Translation & Meaning:

"Members of the Yarnao cooperative unite shoulder to shoulder in all terrace farm work."
"Today on my paddy, tomorrow on yours, supporting one another with joy and vigor."
"Under monsoon clouds, the terrace transplanting is accomplished through shared solidarity."

Procedural Sequence / Observance Steps:

1. Formation of peer labor groups (Yarnao) among youths of similar age cohorts.
2. Scheduling rotational workdays covering each member’s terraced fields sequentially.
3. Mutual provision of noon meal and rice beverage by the host household.
4. Singing of rhythmic working chants to pace transplantation and weeding.
5. Equal reciprocity: Each member owes an exact day of labor to every cohort member.

Ceremonial Participants & Roles:

Youth and Adult Farming Cohorts, Host Households